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# Lesson 4: Classification and Evaluation Metrics

## Technologies for Artificial Intelligence

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23 October 2026

# Before we start

- Exercise 3, which we discuss now
- Ridge, Lasso, and the choice of the penalty strength

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# Today: from a number to a decision

- Logistic regression: the model and why the cost had to change
- The confusion matrix, and why accuracy lies
- Precision, recall, F1, and the threshold nobody chose
- Receiver operating characteristic (ROC) curves, and where they mislead
- Choosing a threshold from money

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# The question has changed

- Lesson 3: given a house, **how many euros?**
- Lesson 4: given a disk drive, **will it fail?**
- Answer with a probability: $0 \leq P(y = 1 \mid x) \leq 1$
- $y = 1$ if the drive failed, $y = 0$ if not; $x$ holds its six counters

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# The fleet

- **8,000 disk drives** in a data centre
- Six SMART counters each: Self-Monitoring, Analysis and Reporting Technology
- Label: did it fail within thirty days?
- `train_test_split(..., stratify=y)`: 6,000 to train, 2,000 to test

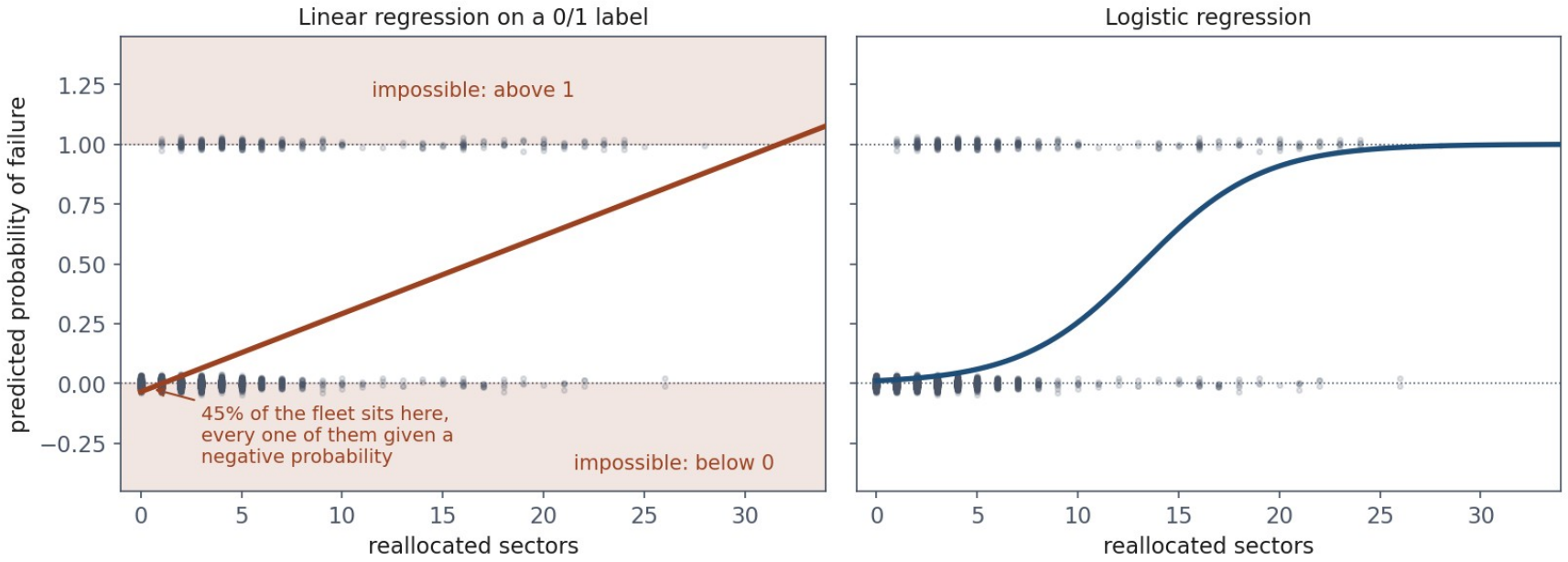
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# 306

- **306 of the 8,000 drives failed.** 3.8% of the fleet
- Which means 96.2% did not

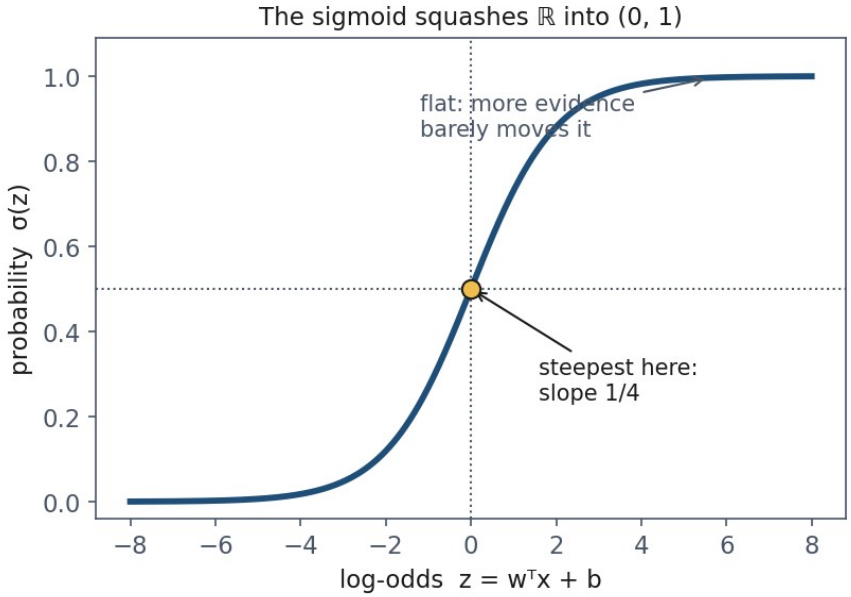
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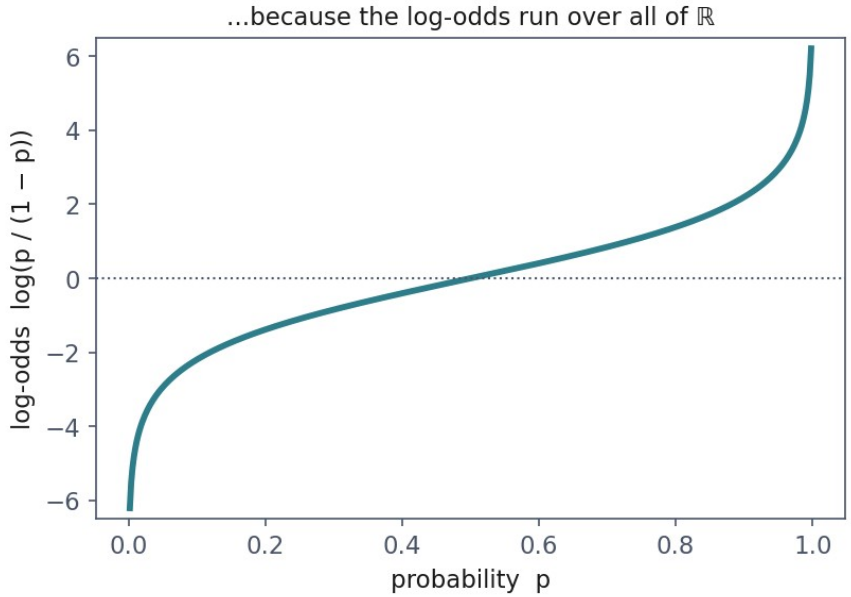
# What goes wrong if we just fit a line




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# The sigmoid




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# The model, in one line

$$P(y = 1 \mid x) = \sigma(w^\top x + b), \qquad \sigma(z) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-z}}$$

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# What the coefficients mean

- The model is linear in the log-odds, log(p ÷ (1 − p)), so `exp(coefficient)` multiplies the **odds**, p ÷ (1 − p)
- Features standardised, so one unit = one standard deviation
- A coefficient of 1.80 means **six times the odds** of failing
- In code: `make_pipeline(StandardScaler(), LogisticRegression())`

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# The truth, and what we recovered

| Feature | True | Fitted | Odds × |
|---|---|---|---|
| reallocated_sectors | 1.80 | 1.66 | 5.28 |
| spin_retry_count | 1.15 | 1.17 | 3.22 |
| read_error_rate | 0.85 | 0.87 | 2.39 |
| temperature_c | 0.45 | 0.47 | 1.59 |
| power_on_hours | 0.35 | 0.38 | 1.46 |
| seek_error_rate | **0.00** | **0.02** | **1.03** |

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# The intercept is the average drive’s chance

- Fitted intercept: **−6.09**
- σ(-6.09) = 0.0023: a 0.2% chance for a drive average on every counter
- The fleet fails at 3.8%: the failures come from the few drives far above average

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# Fitting means minimising something, but what?

- Squared error worked for lesson 3
- Why not just apply it to the sigmoid’s output?

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# Maximum likelihood, in one sentence

- The parameters w and b are a knob: each setting gives a probability to what actually happened
- **Turn the knob so that what actually happened is least surprising**

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# Cross-entropy, also called log loss

$$L = -[\, y \log p + (1-y) \log(1-p)]$$

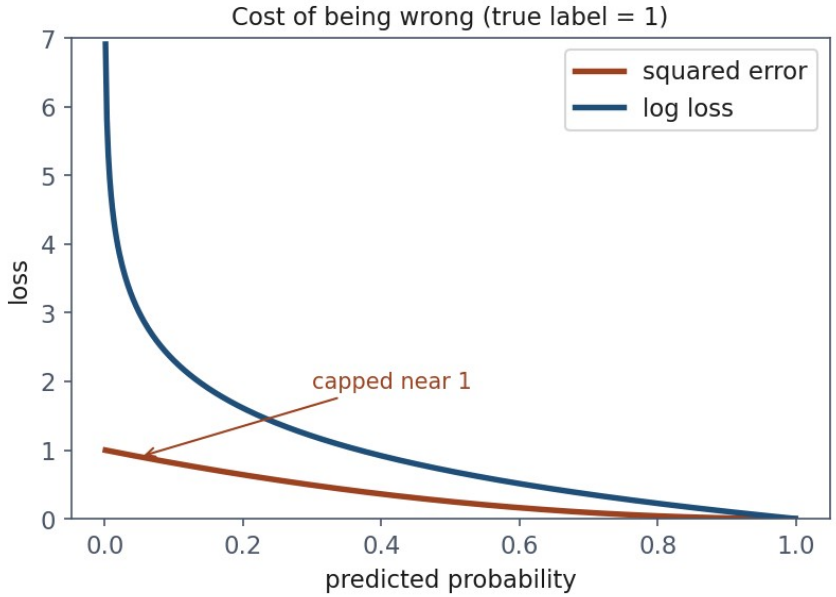
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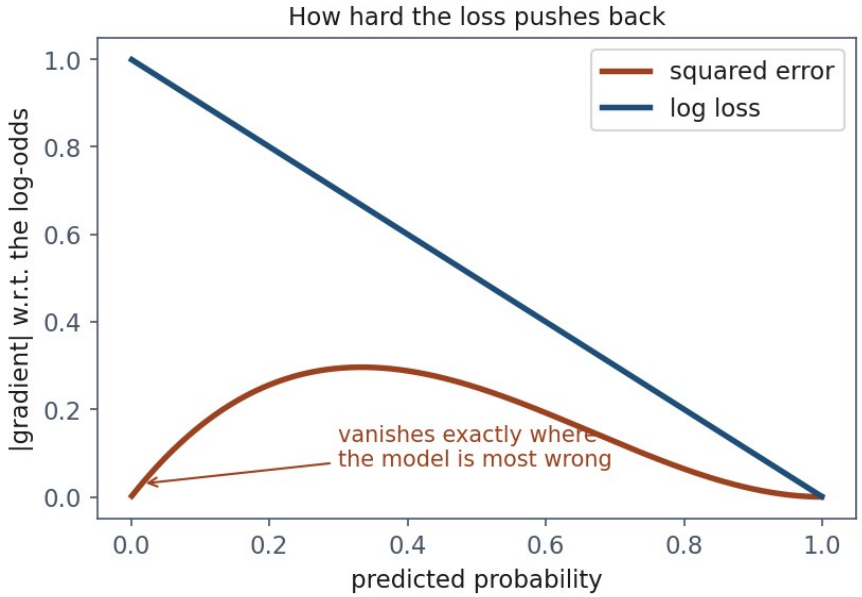
# The gradient is the one you already know

$$\frac{\partial J}{\partial w_j} = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^{m} (\hat{y}^{(i)} - y^{(i)}) x_j^{(i)}$$

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# So why not squared error?




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# And it is convex, which squared error is not

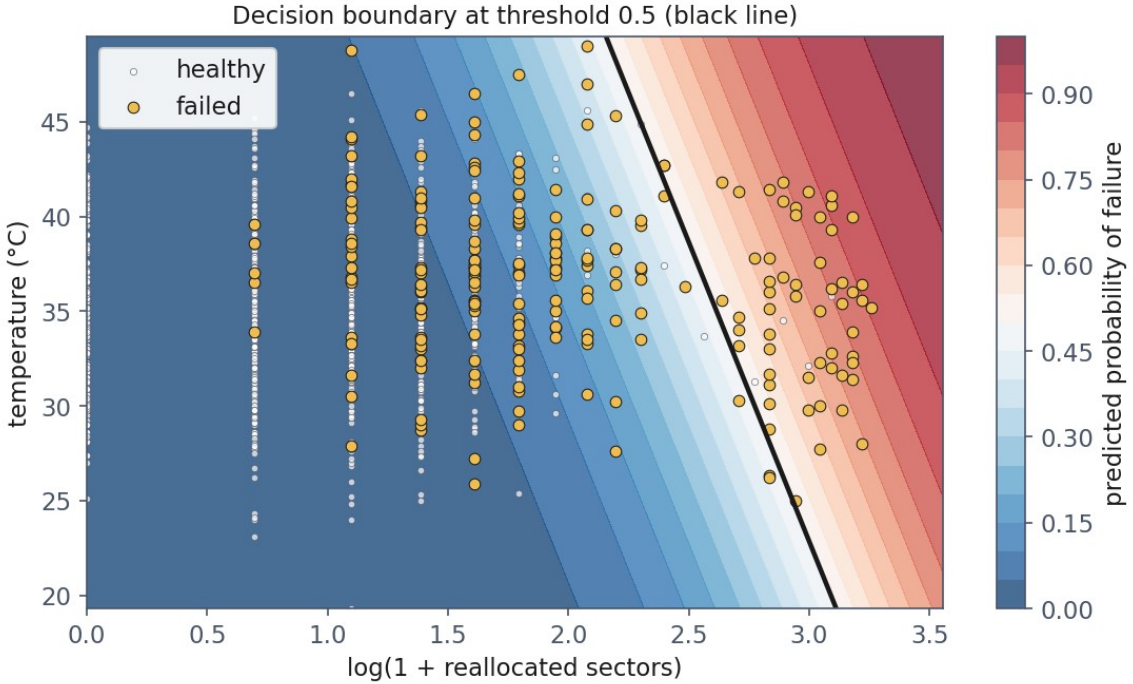
- Log loss is **convex** in the weights, so any local minimum is global
- Squared error through a sigmoid is not

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# Notebook 1, live

| section, and its slides | you call (→ the number to come back with) |
|---|---|
| a line on a 0/1 label, 7 | `LinearRegression` → 3,606 negative probabilities |
| odds, and why not squared error, 8-18 | NumPy only: the sigmoid, the two losses, their gradients |
| gradient descent, 16 | `train_test_split`, `StandardScaler`, fifteen lines of NumPy → log loss 0.6931 to 0.0692 |
| the decision boundary, 20 | `make_pipeline(StandardScaler(), LogisticRegression())` on two features |
| the truth, recovered, 11-12 | `LogisticRegression`, `.coef_`, `.intercept_` → seek_error_rate 0.02, intercept −6.09 |

# The decision boundary




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# Break

- Ten minutes

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# Two models

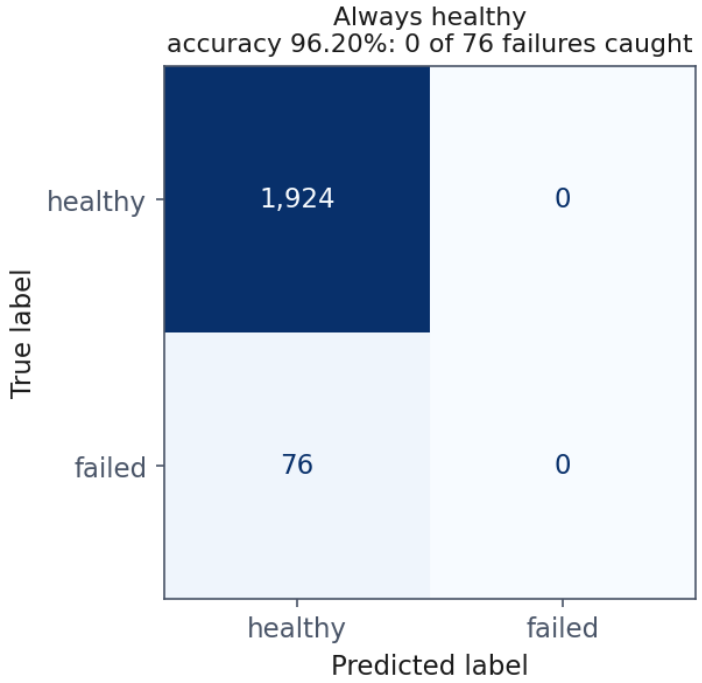
| Model | Accuracy | Failures caught |
|---|---|---|
| Predict “healthy” for everything | **96.20%** | **0 of 76** |
| Logistic regression, threshold 0.5 | 97.70% | 43 of 76 |

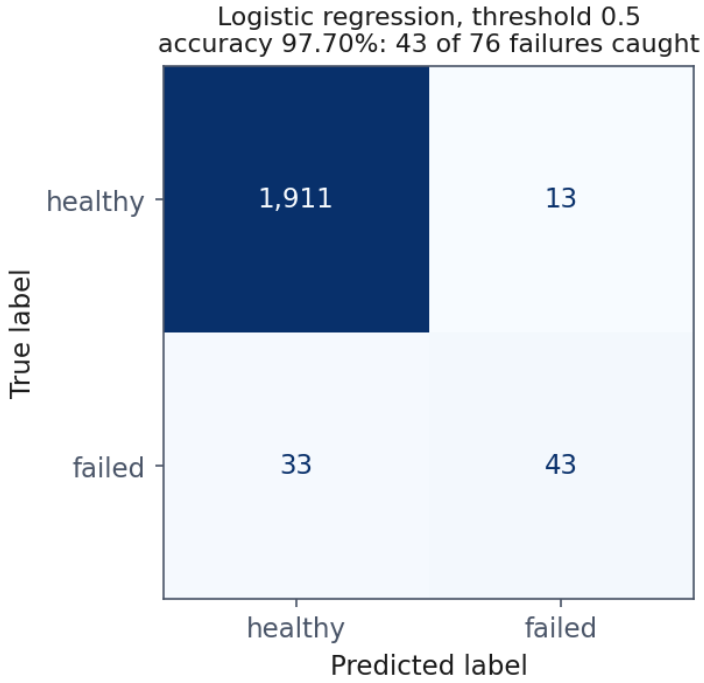
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# Why everyone makes this mistake once

- Accuracy is the fraction of predictions that were right
- On a **balanced** problem that is exactly what you want
- The interesting class is almost always the **rare** one

# Four numbers instead of one




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# The four outcomes, and what they cost

- **False positive**: we replace a healthy drive. A technician’s hour, €140
- **False negative**: a drive dies in service. Callout, rebuild, risk, €2,600

# Precision and recall: look at the denominator

Precision = TP / (TP + FP)
"of the alarms we raised"

| | predicted healthy | predicted failing |
|---|---|---|
| actually healthy | TN<br>1911 | **FP**<br>13 |
| actually failed | FN<br>33 | **TP**<br>43 |

Recall = TP / (TP + FN)
"of the drives that failed"

| | predicted healthy | predicted failing |
|---|---|---|
| actually healthy | TN<br>1911 | FP<br>13 |
| actually failed | **FN**<br>33 | **TP**<br>43 |

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# Our model, in those terms

- True and false positives and negatives: TP, FP, FN, TN
- Precision = TP ÷ (TP + FP) = 43 ÷ 56 = **0.768**: of the drives flagged
- Recall = TP ÷ (TP + FN) = 43 ÷ 76 = **0.566**: of the drives that failed
- Specificity = TN ÷ (TN + FP) = 1,911 ÷ 1,924 = 0.993
- In code: `precision_score`, `recall_score`

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# F1: why the harmonic mean

| Model | Precision | Recall | Arithmetic mean | Harmonic, F1 = 2PR ÷ (P + R) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Flag every drive | 0.038 | 1.000 | 0.519 | **0.073** |

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# Read the minority class, not the average

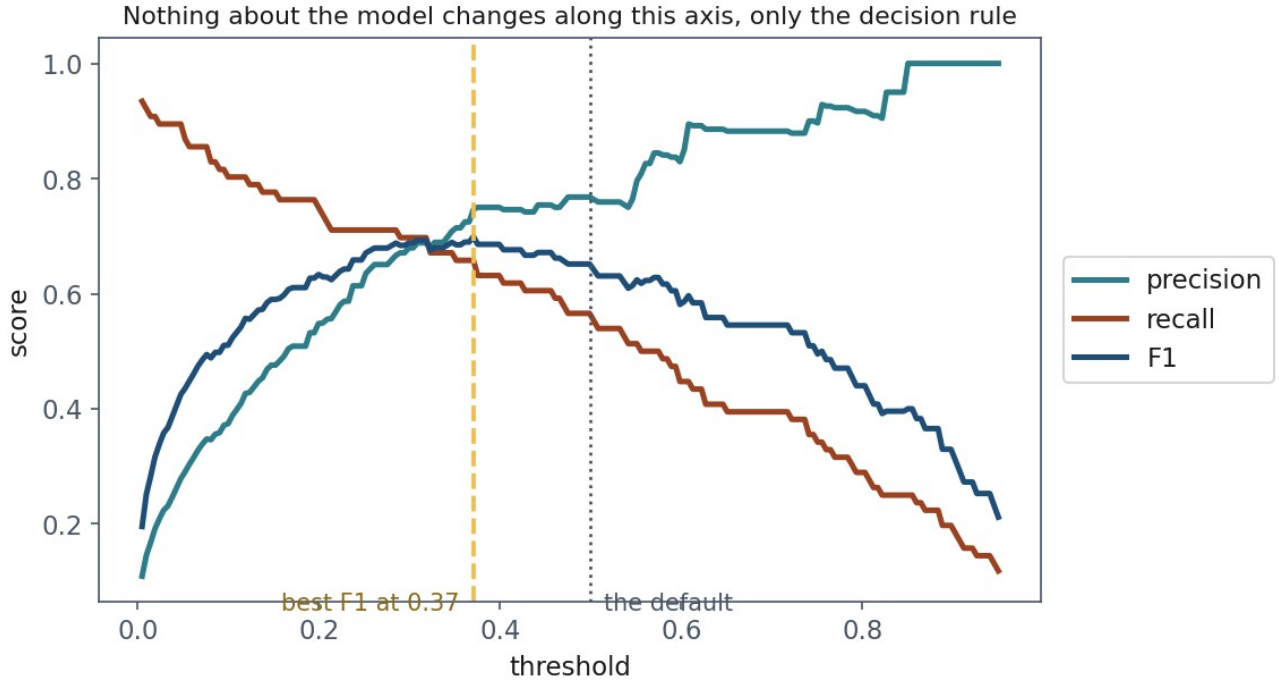
- `weighted avg` F1: **0.975** (dominated by the healthy class)
- `macro avg` F1: **0.820** (both classes get an equal say)
- In code: `classification_report(y_test, y_pred)` prints both rows

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# Notebook 2, live

| section, and its slides | you call (→ the number to come back with) |
|---|---|
| the number that should worry you, 22 | `accuracy_score` → 96.20% for “always healthy” |
| the confusion matrix, 24 | counts by hand, then `confusion_matrix`, `ConfusionMatrixDisplay` → TP 43 |
| precision and recall, 26-29 | `precision_score`, `recall_score`, `f1_score`, `classification_report` |
| the threshold sweep, 31-32 | `predict_proba`, then the metrics at each threshold |
| the precision-recall curve, 33 | `precision_recall_curve`, `average_precision_score` → 0.717 against 0.038 |

# The threshold is a choice nobody made



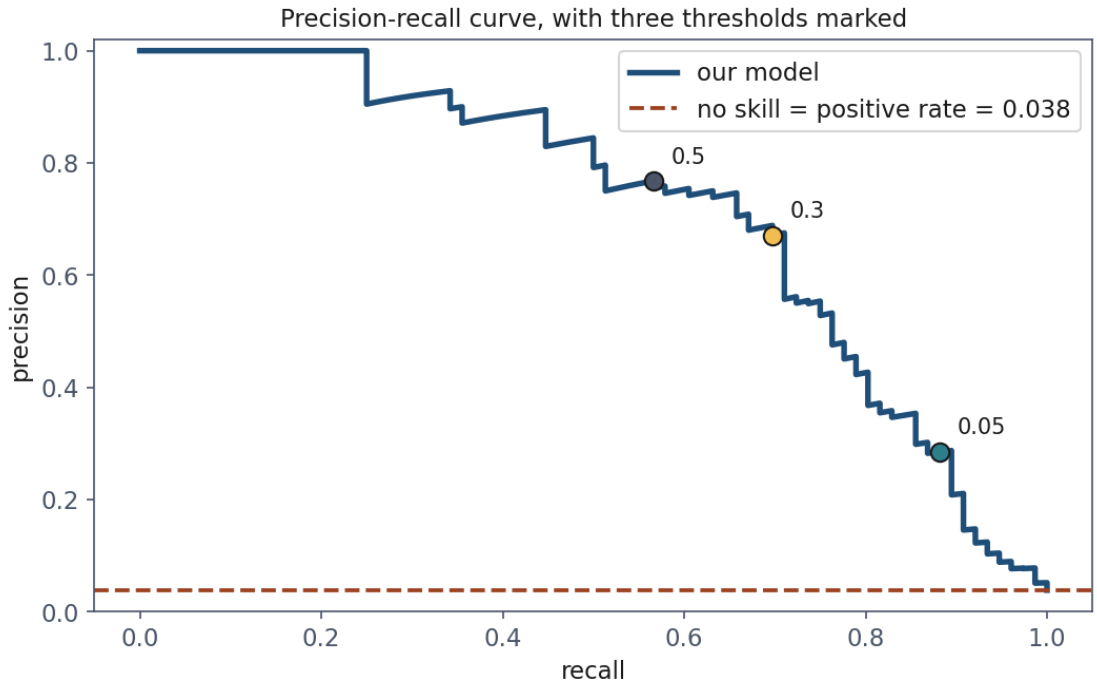

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# What the sweep actually costs

| Threshold | TP | FP | FN | Precision | Recall | Accuracy |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0.02 | 69 | 284 | 7 | 0.195 | 0.908 | 0.855 |
| 0.10 | 61 | 102 | 15 | 0.374 | 0.803 | 0.942 |
| 0.30 | 53 | 25 | 23 | 0.679 | 0.697 | 0.976 |
| 0.50 | 43 | 13 | 33 | 0.768 | 0.566 | **0.977** |
| 0.90 | 14 | 0 | 62 | 1.000 | 0.184 | 0.969 |

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# The precision-recall curve



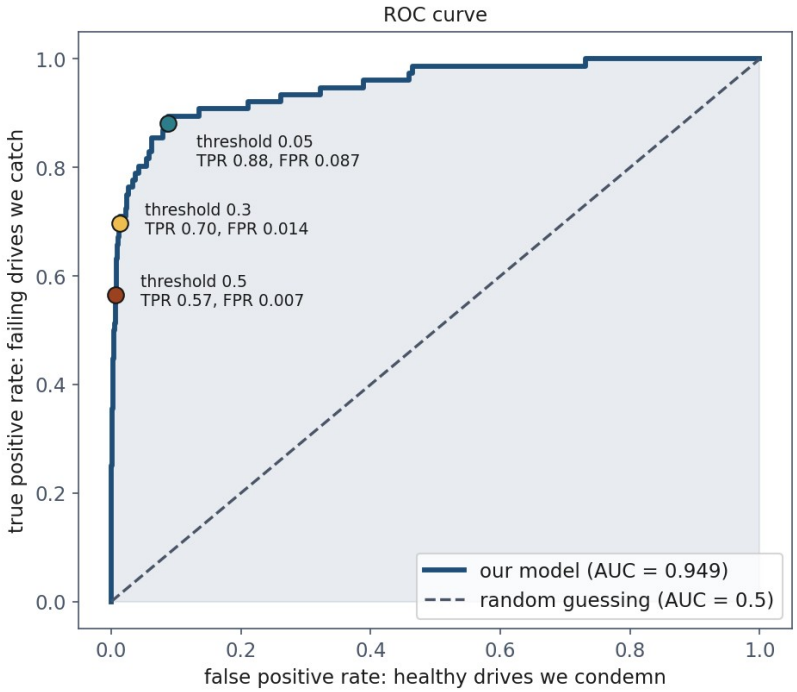

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# Comparing models without choosing a threshold

- We keep evaluating at one threshold, but which?
- What if we score the whole **ranking** instead?

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# The ROC curve




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# What the area means

- **Area under the curve (AUC) = the probability that a random failing drive scores above a random healthy one**
- Ours: 0.949
- In code: `roc_auc_score(y_test, scores)`

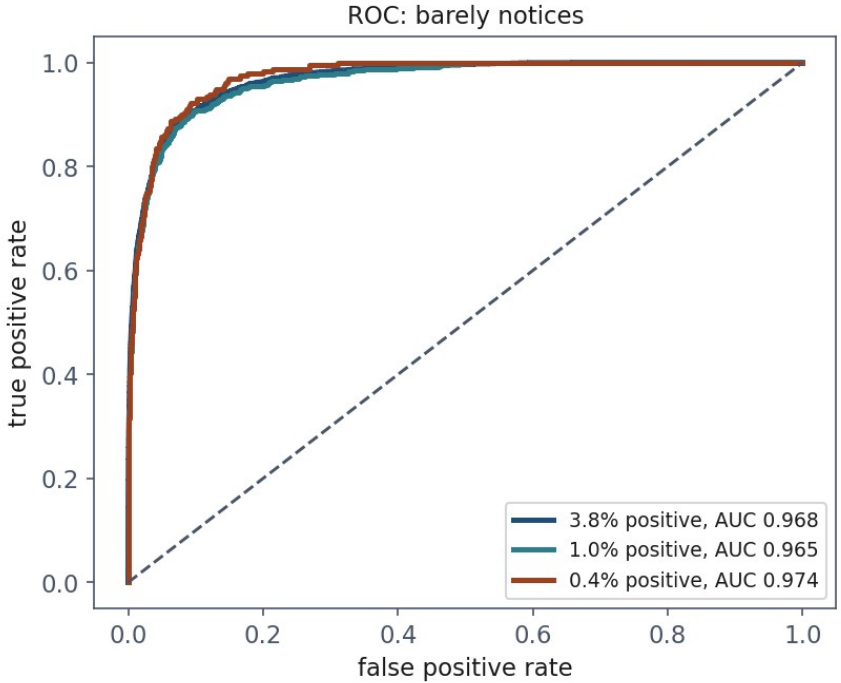
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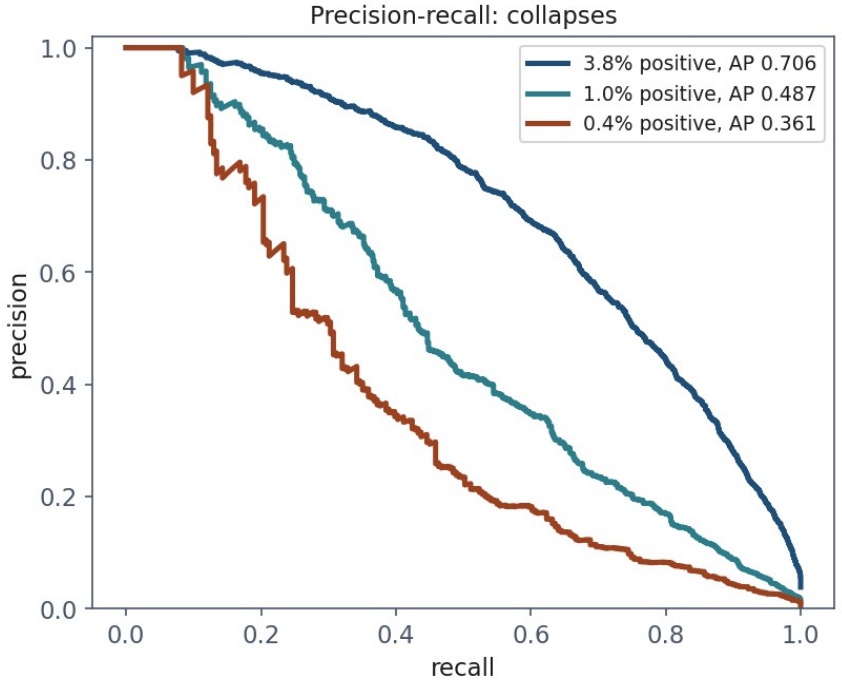
# What AUC does not tell you

- Divide every predicted probability by 10
- AUC is **unchanged**; every decision changes

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# Where ROC misleads




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# Why the two disagree

- False positive rate (FPR) divides by **all healthy drives**: an enormous, growing denominator
- Precision divides by **the alarms raised**, where the false ones dominate

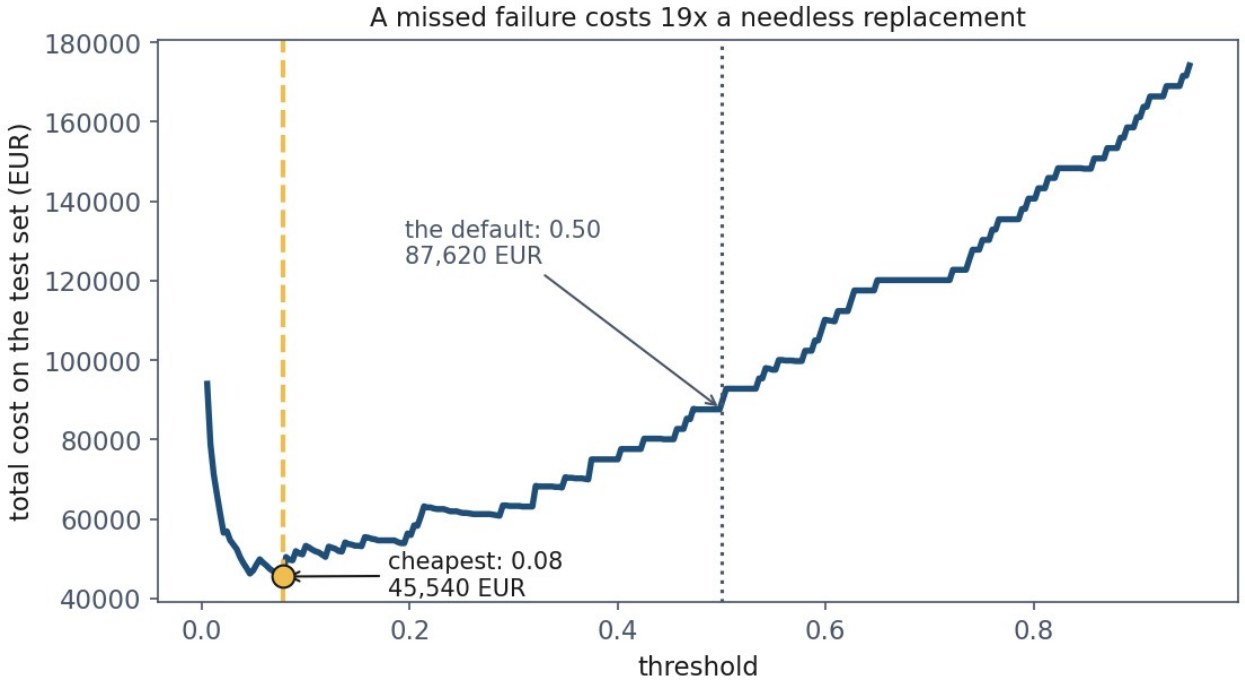
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# The rule

- On an imbalanced problem, report the **precision-recall curve alongside AUC**
- Never instead of it, and never AUC alone
- Its area is the **average precision**, `average_precision_score`: 0.717 here, against a floor of 0.038

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# Choosing the threshold from money




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# And it has a closed form

$$t^* = \frac{C_{FP}}{C_{FP} + C_{FN}} = \frac{140}{140 + 2600} = 0.051$$

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# The caveat you must state

- We chose the threshold **by looking at the test set**
- That is precisely what lesson 1 forbade

# Class weights: the same lever, pulled earlier

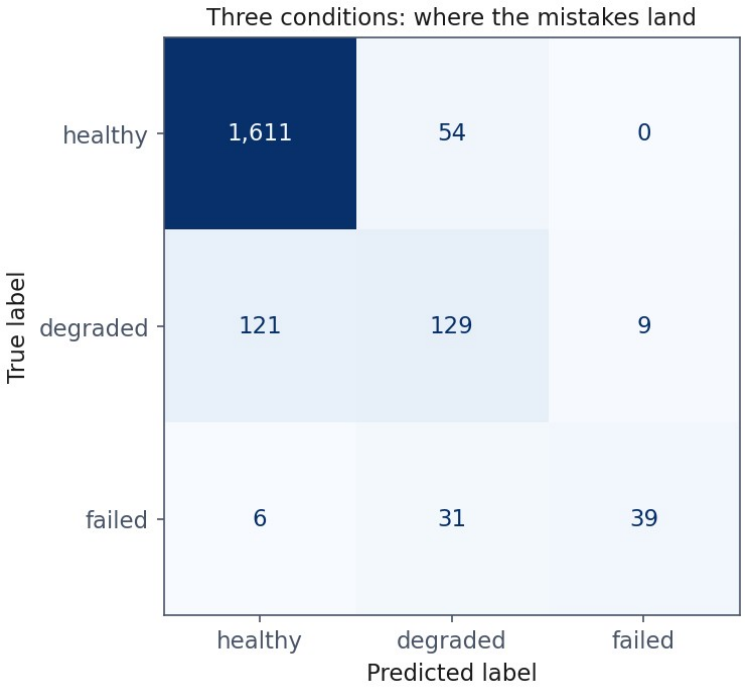
| Model | Recall | Precision | AUC | Cost |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Plain, threshold 0.50 | 0.566 | 0.768 | 0.949 | 87,620 |
| Plain, threshold 0.08 | 0.855 | 0.349 | 0.949 | 45,540 |
| Balanced class weights, 0.50 | 0.895 | 0.249 | **0.950** | 49,500 |

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# Notebook 3, live

| section, and its slides | you call (→ the number to come back with) |
|---|---|
| the ROC curve by hand, 35 | `roc_curve`, `roc_auc_score` → 0.9493 |
| what AUC means, 36 | 200,000 random (failing, healthy) pairs → 0.9488 |
| the rare-positive trap, 38-39 | `average_precision_score` beside `roc_auc_score` → AP 0.706 to 0.361, AUC unmoved |
| the threshold from costs, 41-43 | `confusion_matrix` at each threshold → 45,540 EUR at 0.08, against 87,620 at 0.50 |
| class weights, 44 | `LogisticRegression` with balanced class weights → AUC 0.950 |
| three classes, 46-47 | `classification_report` → macro F1 0.707, weighted 0.883 |

# More than two classes




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# Macro against weighted, one last time

- macro avg F1: **0.707**
- weighted avg F1: **0.883**

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# What to take away

- **96.20% accuracy, nothing caught.** Accuracy measures the majority class
- Precision is about the **alarms**, recall is about the **failures**
- The **threshold is a decision**, and it has a formula
- **AUC measures ranking** and hides imbalance

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# Homework

- **Exercise 4**, discussed at the start of **Friday 30 October**
- Build a classifier, choose a threshold from a stated cost ratio, defend it

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